As in the past, Erdoğan accused Israel of perpetrating a "systematic genocide" against Palestinians. "Since 1948, we have been witnessing this attempt at systematic genocide every day and every month," he said in his speech in the AK Party meeting, at which he wore a keffiyeh. "But above all we are witnessing this attempt at systematic genocide every Ramadan" [14] A particularly toxic libel, Erdoğan was implying that Israel conducts its battles deliberately during the Muslim holy month. Erdoğan has long presented himself as a champion of the Palestinian cause and leader of the entire Sunni Muslim world, but his anti-Israel rhetoric reached new heights during Operation Protective Edge, with comments aimed at causing the maximum offense to the Jewish state by comparing its strategy in Gaza to the actions of Nazi Germany. This time, too, Erdoğan accused Israel of being a "terrorist state that commits 'genocide' in Gaza," but unlike the past, this time Erdoğan added that not only does he stand behind his comparison between Israel and Hitler, but that "Israel has 'surpassed what Hitler did' in Gaza." He compared the mentality of some elements in Israeli society to that of Adolf Hitler.[15] Erdoğan further stepped up his verbal attacks on Israel on July 30, 2014, again comparing the Jewish State to the Third Reich:

> When one explains the similarity between what Israel does and what Hitler and the Nazis did, it makes some uncomfortable. I am addressing the world from Van. What is the difference between what the government of Israel does and what Hitler and the Nazis did? How can you explain what the State of Israel does in Gaza, in Palestine, if not as a holocaust? This is racism. This is fascism. This resurrects the soul of Hitler. Hitler said: "We can be unmerciful, but when we save Germany the world will be a merciful place. We can be unjust, but when we save Germany justice will come to the world. We can be immoral, but when we save our people the path towards a moral world will be paved." Hitler adhered to these very perverted thoughts. He caused the death of millions of humans. He carried out a merciless holocaust on the Jews. Israel is currently saying the same as what Hitler said. The State of Israel is doing the same as what Hitler did. Israel is trying to fool the world saying self-defense for what is exhibited as mercilessness, injustice, immorality. How unfortunate that most countries in the world are also fooled. When we speak out, they immediately try to silence us by calling us anti-Semites. According to the Westerners, it is legal to murder a Muslim. But when it comes to a Jew, it is not. We say that anti-Semitism is a crime against humanity. Islamophobia is also a crime against humanity. You will behave in an inhumane way anyhow; you will kill the children in

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,